SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER · PRODUCT & DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS

Dhayanand Baskar

Building products end to end, from user workflows and APIs to distributed systems that stay reliable at scale.

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01 PROFILE

Software engineer with 12+ years of experience delivering products end to end across HR technology, logistics, mobility, and SaaS. Brings deep distributed-systems expertise and hands-on full-stack experience, including TypeScript and Node.js services on GCP in production alongside Java and Kotlin platforms. Turns complex user and business problems into reliable systems and measurable outcomes.

01 THOUGHTWORKS / GRAB

3B+

rides completed across Southeast Asia at Jan 2019 platform scale; built real-time driver order assignment and lifecycle systems

02 PERSONIO

4M+

employee time-off and vacation balances handled by the materialization platform I led, used by payroll and reporting

JAVA · KOTLIN · SPRING BOOT
AWS · POSTGRESQL

03 FORTO

End-to-end transport tracking

built and operated production shipment-tracking services that stayed correct when third-party updates arrived late, duplicated, or out of order

TYPESCRIPT · NODE.JS · GCP

02 SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Personio

Jun 2022 – Present

Senior Software Engineer · Berlin

- **Main engineering driver** for absence-management capabilities, owning problem framing, technical direction, implementation, migrations, rollout, observability, and production support across employee, HR, payroll, and reporting workflows.
- Reduced Absence Balance API latency by **~70% at P95 and ~60% at P99** through query optimization, batching, workload isolation, and database tuning, eliminating timeout failures for a high-impact customer.
- Led a materialization platform covering **4M+ employee time-off and vacation balances**, replacing expensive read-time calculation with reporting-ready snapshots used by payroll and reporting; priority-aware processing completed million-employee backfills in hours rather than days.
- Built continuous verification for stored and live balance calculations, with discrepancy classification, dashboards, alerts, and runbooks; redesigned a fragile bug-impact analysis from **three days to about four hours**.
- Drove a **payroll-critical holiday platform** from historically correct employee-office logic through automated third-party maintenance and targeted change propagation to Time Off, Attendance, Overtime, and Payroll.

Forto

Sep 2019 – May 2022

Full-stack Software Engineer · Berlin

- **Built and operated TypeScript and Node.js services on GCP in production for a year**, owning transportation-management workflows, APIs, domain models, and external partner integrations end to end.
- Designed GCP-hosted event-ingestion flows that normalized third-party tracking updates and remained correct when events arrived late, duplicated, or out of order.
- Modelled long-running partner bookings as explicit state machines with safe transitions, retries, reconciliation, and failure recovery; used domain-driven design and event storming with logistics specialists to build a shared Transport Plan model and automate workflows incrementally.

03 CORE EXPERTISE

PRODUCT & ARCHITECTURE

End-to-End Delivery
Distributed Systems
Event-Driven Architecture
Domain-Driven Design
State Machines · REST APIs

LANGUAGES

Java · Kotlin
TypeScript · JavaScript
Node.js · Spring Boot

DATA & PLATFORM

PostgreSQL · MySQL
Oracle · MongoDB
GCP · AWS · Kubernetes
Messaging · CI/CD

SCALE PATTERNS

Caching · Materialization
Idempotency · Retries
Outbox · Reconciliation
Eventual Consistency
Workload Isolation

ENGINEERING

Performance Tuning
Reliability · Observability
Automated Testing
Incident Response
Technical Leadership
Mentoring · Design Reviews

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04 EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Thoughtworks / Grab

Dec 2017 – Sep 2019

Full-stack Software Engineer · Bengaluru

- Built Android and backend capabilities for real-time order delivery and the assignment lifecycle from offer through acceptance, rejection, navigation, and completion while Grab operated at **3B+ completed rides** across Southeast Asia.
- As the **sole engineer for driver recognition**, partnered directly with Product and Design to shape milestones, streaks, and profile badges, then delivered the Android flow, APIs, metric aggregation, milestone detection, and badge awarding.
- Improved driver navigation and contributed to a Google ride-hailing integration, coordinating changes across the mobile app, backend APIs, and partner systems.

Whatfix

May 2017 – Dec 2017

Full-stack Software Engineer · Bengaluru

- Built a full-stack product-analytics platform spanning instrumentation, backend APIs, data aggregation, and user-facing reporting for engagement with Whatfix's SaaS onboarding and interactive guidance products.

Mphasis

Jul 2014 – May 2017

Full-stack Software Engineer · Pune

- Built full-stack capabilities for Sprint's telecom ordering system across order capture, validation, enterprise workflows, backend orchestration, relational data, and user-facing interfaces while preserving compatibility and production stability.

05 EVIDENCE OF OWNERSHIP

Leads difficult work from an ambiguous problem to a measurable, operable production system.

01 Set direction

Authored designs and phased technical roadmaps for balance materialization and holiday-data platforms.

02 Protect correctness

Built continuous verification, discrepancy classification, and recovery workflows for payroll-sensitive data.

03 Operate what ships

Defined dashboards, alerts, runbooks, backfills, and production-support paths alongside implementation.

04 Simplify deliberately

Used transactional outbox and FIFO grouping to make event delivery reliable without custom locking.

05 Bring teams along

Coordinated Product, Payroll, Reporting, and platform consumers through migrations and staged rollouts.

06 EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology — 2010 – 2014

Anna University · Chennai

07 ADVANCED STUDY

Algorithms — 2018 – 2019

Princeton University

Advanced Distributed Systems Design — 2020

SOA & DDD · Particular Software

08 HOW I LEAD

SET DIRECTION

Turn ambiguous domains into clear boundaries, design documents, API contracts, and phased technical roadmaps.

RAISE THE BAR

Use design reviews, pragmatic testing, code reviews, and mentoring to improve both systems and engineering judgment.

SHIP SAFELY

Prefer observable, reversible rollouts with migration plans, compatibility guarantees, measurable SLOs, and explicit ownership.